Justinian Mugasha - The Place You Come From

Translated and Edited by P.S.

The Place You Come From is rich in poetic imagery. Metaphor, in fact, is the pivot on which the action of the ballad turns. As in the ballads King Kaitaba and Mugasha, the dramatic energy propelling the main plot is released by a controlled, explosive, verbal exchange in which an insult is conveyed to a person who will not stand for it. In The Place You Come From, the exchange is poetic and in the genre called oku-shambagiza, "to evaluate a person or social entity through metaphoric comparisons." In this genre, the evaluation is usually valorization, and the comparisons are praises. But in the case presented in the present ballad, the comparison is insulting. To prepare for that verbal detonation, to build its dramatic and semantic inevitability, the bard surrounds events leading up to it with a rich filigree of poetic imagery. After the insult, first to heighten and finally to resolve the explosive conflict it ignites, the poet reveals a socio-aesthetic ideology that disambiguates interpretation and rationalizes judgment, or nearly so. These poetic and narrative events are in the comic mode. All ends well for the protagonists who have our sympathy, and their way is marked with some amusement, at least for the audience. The ballad concludes with an extended metaphor on the same subject as that of the motivating insult, which is as life affirming and mirth producing as the insult is spiteful. The imagery and themes of the ballad come, of course, from Haya social imagination and poetic creativity, as these have been shaped for and by the ballad genre. The figures and topics themselves fit well in their performance settings. They are near at hand and on the mind at wedding celebrations, a king's court, or today's public bars. Justinian Mugasha performed this at a bar in Nyamugonga, in Kihanja, Kagera Region, on December 1, 1968.

The Place You Come from — I Was Born There
The Place You Come from — I Was Born There

"The place you come from — I was born there
The place you come from — I was born there
Tell me where you were born,
And I'll tell you where I was born.

You're from Lubya, I'm from Ijumbi.
Cow-sisters' children breed well together.
Tell me where you were born,
And I'll tell you where I was born.

I was born in Katoma *of kinshwi*,
You were born in Bulembo *of yojwe*.
Tell me where you were born,
And I'll tell you where I was born.

You're a child of the Ikanoni river,
I'm a child of the cattle roads,
The cattle roads to Itongo,
And others to Ilogelo.

You're a child of the Bigwanemba
Of They-bellow-not from Lake Ikimba.
I chopped a tree down in Ngalama, they say,
And the branches hit a house,
And twigs hit a house.

Mbali Oluga Niyo Nzalwa.
Nti Mbali Oluga Niyo Nzalwa.

"Mbali oluga niyo nzalwa.
Mbali oluga niyo nzalwa.
Olangambila mbali ozalwa,
Na `nye nkugambile mbali nzalwa.

Oluga Lubya, Nduga Ijumbi.
Obwihwa bumo buteg' ente.
Olangambila mbali ozalwa,
Na `nye nkugambile mbali nzalwa.

Nzalwa Katoma *k' ekinshwi*,
Ozalwa Bulembo *bw' eyojwe*.
Olangambila mbali ozalwa,
Na `nye nkugambile mbali nzalwa.

Oli mwana w' emiga Ikanoni,
Ndi mwana w' ebihongolelo.
Ebihongolelo bigya Itongo,
Binunju bigya Ilogelo.

Oli mwana *w' Ebigwanemba*,
W' Ebitabologa bya Ikimba.
Bahi nkatema omuti Ngalama,
N' amashanju gakatel' enju,
N' amatagi gakatel' enju."

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 1-14:
The comic ballad *The Place You Come from Is Where I Was Born* concerns a brief, adulterous affair between a man and a woman who grew up together but did not marry. The seduction begins (lines 1-14) with images that evoke the idea of closeness and familiarity.

Lines 15-23:
Then, in several lines (15-23) he poetically affirms the complementarity between sexes.

NOTES

1 The first two lines seem to announce the identity of the piece. Like some other epics, *The Place You Come From I Was Born* begins *in medias res* with an important rhetorical encounter. Here it is a seduction, and its themes of familiarity and of praise foreshadow the events to come.

8 Children of sisters: This sentence is used proverbially to suggest that familiarity is a basis for sexual activity, the tenor of other parts of this verbal seduction as well. To my knowledge, the sentence is not used proverbially in conversation.

19 Bigwanemba: not known.

20 Bellowers: This is a reference to the emamba, the lungfish, whose symbolic associations with women are rich. Lungfish do not bellow when impaled with a fishing spear (even though they make a low barking noise when out of water). They are in a sense a role model for women whose bravery is to remain silent on their wedding night and in giving birth. The latter occasion is the only time when the flesh of the lungfish is not forbidden to women. Men eat lungfish freely.

21 I felled a tree in Ngalama: This is a common element of men's self-praise *(ebyebugo)*, but cutting a tree here also has a sexual connotation which has to do with the practice of pre-coital clitoral stimulation known as *oku-telatela*. Associated with the Haya in general (by themselves) and with the cult of the Bachwezi in particular (see Cory__), the practice is said to distinguish human from animal procreation. It involves rubbing or lightly tapping the penis on the clitoral region to prepare for entry. In the poetic imagination, vaginal fluids stimulated splash on thighs like branches striking a house when the great tree falls.

POETIC STANZAS

1-2: couplet repeated 3-14: verse composed of three stanzas (3-6, 7-10, 11-14) all sharing the same final couplet, and all formed in **aabb**; their initial couplets cohere by repetition (3-4), semantic (proverbial) reference (7-8), and parallelism.

15-18: stanza in **aabb**; both couplets cohere by repetition and parallelism.

19-23: stanza in **aax<u>bb</u>**; both couplets cohere by repetition and parallelism and are divided by an inserted line (21)

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 24-50:
The metaphorical argument continues (lines 24-50), as the man constructs figurative images of lovers and lovemaking (lines 24-28, 36-50) while the woman answers with her own playful metaphors.

NOTES

26 *Ma* is the respectful title of a married woman.

27 Have how you slept: a morning greeting, which, when said between status equals, connotes intimacy like that between siblings or lovers.

29 Play with a thin switch is a traditional form of dalliance. Also, the double entendre here partakes of the same associations as those in line 21.

30 Four-twigged: Four, *ina*, is sometimes employed in punning reference to desire, the verbal form for which is *okw-ina*.

36 Drink a brotherhood: Blood brotherhoods were the exclusive prerogative of men. The term is used here to refer generally once more to a form of familiarity and more particularly, to the region just below the navel from which a drop of blood was traditionlly drawn to enact the pact. The drop was placed on a coffee berry and eaten by one's opposite partner in the relationship.

38 Black snakes: This is said to be a praise for the blackness and smoothness of her body. Snakes are also the animating agent of desire; each person has one within.

47 Something: the referent is love.

POETIC STANZAS

24-28: stanza in **aa**x**bb**; couplets cohere by repetition (24-25) and semantic inference (27-28) and are divided by an inserted line (26).

29-35: alternately a stanza in annular structure - **abcba** - formed by pairs of repeated lines (**a**'s: 29-30, 34-35) contrasted with single lines of interrogative syntax (**b**'s: 31, 33) contrasted with a single line of indicative syntax (the placement of locutives in 30 and 34 supports this construction);

Stand still there, let me beguile you," he said.
"Stand still there, let me beguile you well.
You Ma Kilondo *of the Mountain*.
This is the greeting I would give you: 'Sleep well?'
They'll think we have one father."

"That little switch of twigs of yours," she said,
"That little switch of twigs in fours,
Whom did you cut that to hit?"
"I cut it to hit you!"
"Hitting, punishing me so! For what?"
"I punish you for your mistakes," he said,
I'm punishing you for your mistakes.

I asked you long ago to be blood brothers," he said.
"I asked you long ago to be blood brothers, you and I.
Child of the black snakes of Bunena,
I asked you long ago to be blood brothers."

"Go stand at the River Ngono," he said,
"Go stand on the Ngono's bank,
And I'll stand on the other Ngono bank.
They'll think us trees that always grew there,
Muhumula trees found there long ago.

Again stand on the Ngono's bank,
And on the other Ngono bank I'll stand.
He said, "I'll fling it to you–catch it!
It itches more than any rash.
It lames more than acanthus thorn.

and a compound stanza in **aab**, 2 + 2 + 3, formed by two couplets whose lines cohere, respectively, by repetition alone and parallelism + repetition (**a**'s: 29-30, 31-32) contrasted with one triplet (**b**: 33-35) whose lines cohere both by repetition + parallelism (33-34) and by repetition alone (34-35).

36-39: stanza in **aaba** formed by contrast between lines that repeat *nkagamba* "I said" + *katunywana* "let us swear a blood brotherhood" (**a**'s: 36, 37, 39) and one composed of praisenames (**b**: 38).

Ati, "Oyemelele nkulembe.
Oyemelele nkulembele.
Iwe Ma Kilondo *kya Ibanga*.
Ngye nkushul', `Olailota?'
Balimanya tuli ishe emoi."

"Akashanju k' amatagiwe,"
Ahi, "Kashanju k' amatagi inai,
Okatemile kutel' owai?"
"Nkatemile kutela iwe."
"Naho nontela nontulaki?"
Ahi, "Inye nkutula amafu gawe,
Inye ninkutula amafu gawe.

Nkagamba katunywana,"
Ahi, "Nkagamba katunywana hamoi.
Mwana w' enjoka zilagula za Bunena,
Nkagamba katunywana."

Ati, "Ogy' oyeme Ngono, Ngono,
Ogy' oyeme Ngono nseli,
Na `nye nyeme Ngono nseli.
Balimanya miti ekamela olwo,
Mihumula ekashangwaho.

Oshub' oyeme Ngono nseli,
Na `nye nyeme Ngono nseli.
Ahi, "Nzikulasile - oitole.
Ibabila zikil' obuhele.
Kazichumbagiza zishaga amatojo.

40-44: stanza in **aaa**x**bb** composed of linegroups that cohere respectively, by repetition of "stand" (inflected in the subjunctive) + "Ngono" (**a**'s: 40-42) and by enjambment (clause in apposition, **b**'s: 43-44).

45-49: stanza in **aax**x**bb** formed by contrast between couplets that cohere, respectively, by repetition (**a**'s: 45-46) and semantics (**b**'s: 48-49) separated by a distinct line type (x: 47).

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 51-61:
The seduction concludes with the man's praise of the woman's beauty and her womanhood (lines 51-59), her figurative acquiescence (line 60), and the singer's literal affirmation of her words.

Lines 62-72:
The lovemaking occurs outside the village in a grove of trees near the fields where women do agricultural work (lines 62-63). It proceeds from literal description of the act (64-65) to emblematic praise for female anatomy (lines 66-69) to metaphorical description of physical sensation.

NOTES

50 My love: *Baba*, from *iba* "husband," a Haya term of address that signifies intimacy, is used in a unmarked way by a woman to her husband and between women agemates; its use from man to woman signifies an unusual degree of intimacy and undifferentiated affection (see also Kachwenyanja, lines 146, 368).

51 Slippery: praise for the smoothness of her body.

57 Mother: *Mawe* literally "my mother," is the respectful term of address for an adult woman. The corresponding term for a man is Father (*Tata*).

59 Kabagala: a short handled hoe with a relatively small, heartshaped head. It is said to be the indigenous form of hoe and is sacred to Nyakalembe, the spirit associated with women per se.

67 Sleeping-sickness: This and the praise in the next line will be explicated as part of the story line, below.

69 Short face, Long nose: Vulva and clitoris, respectively, account for this praise name for the female genetalia.

70 Folding: a lovemaking position in which man and woman sit facing one another; they are 'folded' rather than lying down straight. This is said to be the position characteristic of lovers rather than married people.

POETIC STANZAS

51-53: stanza in **aba** formed by contrast between lines composed as Ø verb + praisename (**a**'s: 51, 53) and a single line containing an adverbial past perfect (**b**: 52).

54-56: stanza in **aab** formed by contrast between lines that repeat *lya* "eat" (**a**'s: 54,55) and a finalizing line that shifts domain of reference and is inflected in the negative.

57-61: stanza in **aaabb** formed by contrast between a linegroup that coheres by composition as praisenames (**a**'s: 57-59) and a couplet that coheres by semantics (statement and exigesis, **b**'s: 60-61).

62-65: stanza in **abaa** formed by contrast between lines that are composed as double verbs (**a**'s: 62, 64, 65) and one line whose verb is an adverbial past perfect.

66-69: stanza in **aaab** formed by contrast between lines that contain simple praisenames (**a**'s: 66, composed as noun or 67, noun + verbal noun phrase or 68, verbal noun phrase alone) and a single line that contains a praisename composed by parallelism (**b**: 69, noun + adjective; noun + adjective).

70-72: stanza in **aabb** formed by contrast between lines that cohere by initial adverbial past perfect verbs (**a**'s: 70-71) and lines that cohere by parallelism: preposition + banana beer constituent + reflexive verb in present continuitive tense (**b**'s: 71.1-72)

50 Dear one, it's you!"

Smoothness of Kijongo, there
Where he had met her,
Ma Kilondo *of the Mountain*.

"Rather than eat your mother's food, I'd eat you," he said.
55 "Those who eat you have acquired a taste.
Stop tormenting me with neighbor's closeness."

"Mother, Mother *Dappled-cow*, *Oft-spoken-of*," he said,
"*Spears kill men*,
Hoes are ruled by Kabagala,"
60 "Father *who makes me well*," she answered.
And speaking so, she consented.

The two hid her yams in a mushasha grove,
Near where Kilondo had been washing them.
The two hurried and entered,
65 Undressed and lay down.

He touched her on the thing *Well-spoken-of*,
On the *Sleeping-sickness*, *Killer-of-cattle*,
On the *Plunderer of cattle and their offspring*,
On the *Short face with a long nose*.

70 When he began the folding,
When he entered inside, he found bananas ripe to falling from the stalk,
And higher up, the thick sweet mash kneading itself.

50 Baba iwe!"

Katelela Kijongo kulinya,
Mbali yamutelaine,
Ma Kilondo kya Ibanga.

Ati, "Olwo kulya nyoko, ndyaiwe.
55 Abakulya bakwegomba.
Oleke kunyis' omutulanwa.

Ahi, "Mawe, Mawe *Buyenje Lugambwa*,
Machumu gait' abashaija,
*Nfuka itwalwa Kaba*gala,"
60 Ahi, "Tata *Eyantambile*."
Kayagambile yaikiliza.

Lyagya lyasheleka enumbu omu kashasha,
Mbali Kilondo yabaile nayogeza enumbu.
Lyatela lyataha,
65 Lyabijula lyanyama.

Yakolaho ahali *Mugambwage*,
Ahali *Shotoka Nyamwita-nte*,
Ahali *Munyagis' ente nogwayo*,
Ahali *Buso bugufi Nyindo ndai*.

70 Kayachwile kukunjagala,
Kayayatahile okuzimu yashanga ebihiise nibyehogola.

Aha igulu omulamba gw' omunene nigwekamula.

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 73-98:
Pillow talk follows. The man begins with praise (lines 73-74), then recalls his image of masculine labor (of lines 21-23) to assert the strength of his feeling (lines 75-79), and finishes with more praise of her beauty and an assertion of his passion, this time by comparing it to a spiritual experience (lines 80-84). The woman responds with figurative praise for the male anatomy (lines 85-86) and follows with parallel declarations of passion drawn from a female realm of work (lines 86-97). The pillow talk ends (line 98) with the woman's playful enunciation of the familiar greeting that the man proposed as part of his seduction (see line 27).

Lines 99-101:
The lovemaking ends with a literal description of the couple's actions (99-101) paralleling that at the beginning of the action (see lines 63-65).

NOTES

73 Dappled cow: Of the many named colors and markings of cows, this is said to be the most beautiful.

74 Spears: Love and desire for a woman can be said to pierce a man inside, and can prove a danger to him, as this and other stories attest.

98 Have you slept?: The greeting here echoes that in line 27 and indicates, perhaps, a momentary nap.

POETIC STANZAS

73-98: passage composed of two verses (conversational turns: 73-84 and 85-98) with mirror structure; both verses have three linegroups: an initial three lines of address and praise, patterened by repetition (73-74) or enjambment (85-86.1); and two longer linegroups, containing vows of affection and a rhetorical question - 5-line compound stanza and stanza in the first verse, and 6-line compound stanzas in the second; in the first verse, the compound stanza (75-79) in **aab**, 2 + 2 + 1, is formed by couplets (**a**'s: 75-76, 77-78) internally coherent by syntactical parallelism and contrasted with a single line (**b**: 79); the stanza (80-84) in **aa**a**bb** ia formed by contrast betweeen lines composed as praise (**a**'s: 80-82) and lines that repeat "possess" (**b**'s: 83-84)); in the second verse, both compound stanzas (87-92, 93-98) begin with 3 lines of conditional clauses cohering internally as **aab** (87-89, 93-95); these are followed by 2 lines of subjunctive verbs with imperative force (90-91, 96-97) and finalized by single lines, one that begins with a conditional (92) and one that repeats a rehetorical question (96).

99-101: stanza in **aab** formed by contrast between lines composed as double verbs (**a**'s: 99-100) and a single line which is composed identically, but to which a prepositional phrase has been added (**b**: 101).

"Mother, Mother, Mother, Mother," he said,
"Mother *Dappled-cow*,
Mother *Spears-kill-men*,

"If you visit, if you visit," he said,
"If you find I'm cutting firewood,
The axe I'll throw above,
The hafted-knife I'll throw below.
We'll just walk together talking.

You Ma Kilondo *of the Mountain*,
You *Little calf's foot*,
Mother *Flirting neighbor's eyes*,
Is this not desire? You possess me!
You possess me, you possess me!"

"Father *Canoe-pole of Itojo's ferryman Kyakushengo*," she answered,
That measures the river bottom without a struggle."

And if you visit," she said,
"If you visit, if you visit," she said,
If you find me peeling plantains,
Leave them. I'll wrap them up.
Let those who wanted them put them on the fire.
And if they leave them, let them burn."

"If you visit, if you visit," she continued,
"If you find me with the milk already poured,
And in the dairy room I'm churning,
Just tickle my ribs, I'll spill it out,
And let those who wanted it drink water.
Is this not desire? Sleep well?"

The two lay down and arose,
Went and dressed.
Went and found the yams again.

Ahi, "Mawe, Mawe, Mawe, Mawe,"
Ahi, "Mawe *Buyenje*,"
Ahi, "Mawe *Machumu gait' abashaija*,"

Ahi, "Kolija kolija,"
Ahi, "Kolishanga ninshenya,
Endyamiti nnage kinyalugulu,
Omuholo nnage ekibanga eifo.
Tugende hamoi nitufumola.

Iwe Ma Kilondo kya Ibanga,
Iwe *Kalenge k' enyana nto*,
Mawe *Bishobisho bya njwe*li,
Tikwo kukwohya? Nombanda!
Nombanda, nombanda."

Na wenene ahi, "Tata *Mushomelo*

Gwaguleng' entolo gutaina lwango Gw' omwa Kyakushenga Itojo."

Ahi, "Na `nye kolija,"
Ahi, "Kolija kolija,"
Ahi, "Kolishanga nimpata,
Olibileka, mbifundikile.
Ababyohyile babinegeze,
Kabalibileka bikunune."

Ahi, "Kolija kolija,"
Ahi, "Kolishanga naitile,"
Ndi aha lusiika ninchunda,
Onzigazigite ngashangaze,
N' abagohyile banywe amaizi.
Inye tikwo kukwohya? Olailota?"

Lyanyama lyaimuka,
Lyagya lyajwala.
Lyagya lyagoba aha numbu.

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 102-108:
The woman then offers a bit of food to the man, cutting and peeling a piece from one of the yams she had been harvesting — the kind of snack shared among intimates or given to a child, but here presented honorifically on a banana-leaf platter (lines 102-105). The man begins to refuse it, for it could be seen as food unworthy of his social status, but then he reminds himself of the ethos expressed in a particular proverb and agrees to eat.

Lines 109-120:
The two lovers part and walk a short distance from each other, but then turn and call (lines 109-112), a reflection of a previously proposed seductive metaphor (see lines 40-49). At first, the couple's public exchange language is a veiled reference to their intimacy (lines 113-115). But then the man uses a combination of literal speech and insulting imagery to boast his conquest of, and declare his contempt for, his erstwhile lover.

Lines 121-134:
The woman responds bravely, attributing his disgraceful ethics to low birth and deploring the social shame he has brought her (lines 121-23). Then she challenges the aptness of the man's insulting calabash image by contrasting it, on the one hand, with honorific cattle-based imagery for the same referent (lines 124-27), and on the other hand, to the calabash image's literal meaning (lines 128-33). The man curtly reiterates the aptness of his calabash image.

NOTES

108 Impure: The taking of food in this situation might be considered impure because they have not washed their hands after making love.

124 Drum: another vehicle for alluding to the sexual practice noted above, line 21.

POETIC STANZAS

102-105: stanza in **aab** formed by semantic contrast between syntactically parallel lines that involve one actor (**a**'s: 102-104) and a line that involves two actors (**b**: 105).

The woman Kilondo reached in her basket,
Took some nice kilibwa yams,
Placed them on a banana leaf,
Presented them to the man.

When at first he began to refuse them,
He stopped and thought, "I'll eat these yams.
I know 'The beautiful cannot be impure.'"

When he'd finished eating yams,
The man was then descending,
The woman was then climbing a hill.
He called to her again.

"Mother *Dappled-cow, Oft-spoken-of*," he said,
"*Spears kill men*."
"Father *Who-makes-me-well*," she answered.

"Into your *Broken-mouth-vessel*," he said,
"I threw a clod of earth.
It burst in there.
When you bear a child," he said,
"Call it *Brought-by-Desire*."

She wheeled around at once, Kilondo.
"You commoner's son, you've shamed me!
You've greatly shamed me! you've shamed me!

You took the *Drum of kings and men, the thing Well-spoken-of*,
The Sleeping-sickness, Killer-of-cattle,
The Plunderer of cattle and their offspring,
You call it *a Broken-mouth-vessel*.

106-111: compound stanza in **abab**, 1 + 2 + 1 + 2, formed by contrast between single lines composed as adverbial past perfect + infinitive (**a**'s: 106, 109) and couplets that cohere by enjambment and parallelism, respectively (**b**'s: 107-108, 110-111).

113-115: stanza in **aab** formed by contrast in speakers.

116-120: stanza in **aaabb** formed by linegroups that cohere by enjambment.

Omukazi Kilondo yakolamu omu lugega.
Yaihyamu enumbu ezilungi ezakilibwa.
Yaita aha lubabi.
Yamuteka omu maisho omushaija.

Kayachwile kuzanga,
Yayemamu ahi, "Kandye enumbu ezi.
Nimanya `Ez' omulungi tihagala.'"

Kayamazile kulya enumbu,
Omushaija akaba nasoka,
Omukazi akaba natemba akabanga.
Yashuba yamweta.

Ahi, "Mawe *Buyenje Lugambwa*,
Machumu gait' abashaija."
Ahi, "Tata *Eyantambile*."

Ati, "Omuli *Mashayaye* yawe
Egyo nakujungamu eikote.
Lyakabila omu nda."
Ati, "Kolizala omwana,
Omwete *Kalesilwe-ngonzi*."

Yakebukila kimo Kilondo.
Ahi, "Mwana w' omwilu, wangola!"
Ahi, "Wangola muno wangola."

Ahi, "Watola *Engoma y' abakama n' abashaija Mugambwage,*
Shotoka Nyamwita-nte,
Nyamunyagis' ente n' ogwayo,
Wagyeta *Mashayaye*.

121-123: stanza in **abb** formed by contrast between a single line of narrative and two lines of quoted speech marked by repetition.

124-127: stanza in **abba** formed by contrast between lines composed as 2nd singular verb initial + praisename (**a**'s: 124, 127) and those composed as praisenames alone (**b**'s:125, 126).

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 135-147:
The woman carefully stores her yams at home (lines 135-41), then travels and meets some men and makes her accusation.

Lines 148-162:
She tells the men the story of the encounter and her lover's subsequent insult, and she recounts her arguments against his rhetorical description (lines 148-61). The men, however, agree with the insulting lover.

NOTES

132 Split: Ma Kilondo's definition of a broken-mouth vessel is correct. These two lines repeat a saying that may be used conversationally to attack a loud or long-winded argument: "Nojuga nk' olushusi lw' enanga nilwo lujuga lwatikiile!" "You boom like the calabash of an enanga that booms though it's been split!" i.e., your words, although loud or many, lack substance, are hollow, have no meaning inside. For more Haya metaphorical evaluations of speech, see Seitel 197 .

POETIC STANZAS

128-134: compound stanza in **aba**, 2 + 3 + 2, formed by contrast between couplets formed by repetition and parallelism (**a**'s: 127-128, 133-134) and a triplet that coheres by enjambment (130-132).

135-141: stanza in **aa**aaaa**b** formed by contrast between lines composed as 3rd singular verb initial (**a**'s: 135-140) and a single line with an initial direct object.

142-147: compound stanza in **abab**, 1 + 2 + 1 + 2, formed by contrast between single lines beginning with double verbs (**a**'s: 142, 145) and couplets (**b**'s: 143-44, 146-47) formed by parallelism and repetition, respectively (similar to 106-11).

148-151: stanza in **aabb** formed by couplets that cohere by repetition and parallelism.

152-155: see note for 124-127

156-162: see note for 128-134

It's not a keg calabash for fermented brew.
Nor a tankard for sweet mash.
What they call a *Broken-mouth-vessel*'
Is the resonator for the *enanga*
That's the one that booms though it's been split."
"Mine is *a thing Well-spoken-of*," she declared.
"It's really *a Broken-mouth-vessel*," he said.

She turned around,
Saw her home was near,
Climbed a hill,
Passed two farms,
Reached her forecourt,
Entered the house,
And her harvest basket left; she put it in the inner room.

She went out again without delay,
Descended the hill,
Crossed a stream,
Met two men, and then she began:
"But that man truly shamed me!" she said.
"How did he cause you shame, Mother?" they asked.

"He met me on the path," she said.
He spoke of adult things and I agreed."
We came to lay down," she said,
And when we came to get up,

He took the *Drum of kings and men, the thing Well-spoken-of*,
The Sleeping-sickness, *Killer-of-cattle*,
The Plunderer of cattle and their offspring,
He called it a *Broken-mouth-vessel*.

I declare: It's not a keg calabash for fermented brew,
Nor a tankard for sweet mash.
What they call a *Broken-mouth-vessel*'
Is the resonator for the *enanga*
That's the one that booms though it's been split."
"Mine is a thing *Well-spoken-of*."
"Yes," they agreed, "It's a *Broken-mouth-vessel*."

Mala ti kishusi kya malwa.
Mala ti kilele kya mulamba.
Ekyobeta `*mashayay*e'
Luba lushusi lw' enanga
Nilwo lujuga lwatikile."
Ati, "Eyange ni *Mugambwage*."
Omushaija ahi, "Ni *Mashayaye* kwo."

Yashuba yakubuka.
Yaleba mbali alikugya omwabo ekab' eli hai.
Yatemb' akabanga.
Yahingul' ebibanja bibili.
Yagob' omwabo omu kibuga.
Yataha omu nju.
Olugega yasiga yaluteka enjulugulu.

Yakangayo yagaluka.
Yasongok' akabanga.
Yashabuka omugela.
Akashanga ayemeleile n' abashaija babili.
Ahi, "Kyonka omushaija yangola!"
Bahi, "Yakugozaki mawe?"

Ahi, "Yambuganganwa omu kihanda.
Yangambila eby' abakulu naikiliza."
Ahi, "Twaija twanyama.
Katwaija twaimukile,

Yatola *Engoma y' abakama n' abashaija Mugambwage*,

Shotoka Nyamwita-nte,
Nyamunyagis' ente n' ogwayo,
Yagyeta *Mashayay*e

Nti ti kishusi kya malwa
Mala ti kilele kya mulamba
Ekyobeta `*mashayay*e'
Luba lushusi lw' enanga
Nilwo lujuga lwatikile.
Eyange ni *Mugambwage*"
Bati, "Ego ni *Mashayaye*."

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 163-176:
She takes her accusation to court, but the judges again agree with the man (lines 163-69). She takes her case to a higher court, but the result is the same.

Lines 177-181:
The woman begins to cry, when suddenly the king appears and asks her for the source of her woe.

Lines 182-203:
She tells her story in more detail, explaining to the king about her childhood together with the lover, their plans for marriage, and the disappointment of these plans when the woman's father arranged a marriage with someone else (lines 182-189). She explains she had just emerged from her bridal seclusion (line 190-3) and then recounts the events and revisits the rhetorical arguments she has articulated before.

POETIC STANZAS

163-176: two stanzas repeated incrementally, composed of initial couplet (163-164, 170-171) that coheres by parallelism (verbs in every line in both initial and final positions); then follows a stanza **aabab** formed by contrast between lines composed as noun + modifier + verb (**a**'s: 165, 166, 168 and 172, 173, 175) and lines that repeat one another (**b**'s: 167, 169 and 174, 176).

182-183: stanza in **abab** formed by contrast between lines that begin with a locutive (**a**'s: 182, 183) and lines marked by internal parallelism that restate the previous line (**b**'s: 182.1, 183.1).

184-186: stanza alternately in **abab** formed by lexical contrast between lines that begin in "He comes from" (**a**'s: 184, 185) and those that begin in "I come from" (**b**'s: 184.1, 186); and in **aabb** formed by contrast between lines composed as "come from" + placename (**a**'s: 184, 184.1) and those composed as "come from" + placename + praise (**b**'s: 185, 186).

187-189: stanza in **aab** formed by contrast between lines that are composed as locutive + adverbial particle +: "grow up" (**a**'s: 187-188)

What was once a secret broke open now.
She travelled to the lower court and made her accusation.
All the chairs creaked,
All officials judged,
"Yes," they agreed, "It's a *Broken-mouth-vessel*."
And a royal kinsman also judged,
"Yes," he agreed, "It's a *Broken-mouth-vessel*."

She stiffened her resolve; she went,
She travelled to the higher court and made her accusation.
All the chairs creaked,
And all the elders judged,
"Yes," they agreed, "It's a *Broken-mouth-vessel*."
And the Prime Minister also judged,
"Yes," he agreed, "It's a *Broken-mouth-vessel*."

She wept. Tears fell,
Ma Kilondo *of the Mountain*.
She was weeping there, when the king appeared.
"What makes you weep, woman?" he asked.
She wiped her tears.

"O King," she said, "What makes me weep this flood and bellow and wail,"
Once that man and I loved each other," she said.
"We were young then. We were children.

He's from Lubya,
I'm from Ijumbi.
He's from Katoma *of kinshwi*,
I'm from Bulembo *of yojwe*.

'When you grow up I'll marry you,' he'd say.
But when I grew up, he was not allowed to court me," she said.
"Father betrothed me somewhere else."

and a single line composed differently, that finalizes with "betroth" (**b**: 189).

Eyaba eli enama yayatika.
Yagya omu gombolola yahababa.
Entebe zona zakekela,
Abakungu bona balamula,
Bati, "Ego ni *Mashayaye*"
N' omwami nawe yalamula,
Ati, "Ego ni *Mashayaye*"

Yaguma yagenda.
Yagya omu bulange yahababa.
Entebe zona zakekela,
N' abazee bona balamula,
Bati, "Ego ni *Mashayaye*."
Na katikilo inya yalamula,
Ati, "Ego ni *Mashayaye*."

Yalila gatonya,
Ma Kilondo kya Ibanga.
Kayabaile nalila omukama yahabuka.
Ahi, "Nolizibwaki iwe mukazi?"
Yayelagaza amaziga.

Ahi, "Mukama ekilikundiza amaizi kuchula kubologa,"

Ati, "Omushaija ogu tukagonzanganya
Tuli bato tuli bana.

Naluga Lubya,
Ninduga Ijumbi.
Naluga Katoma k' *ekinshwi*,
Ninduga Bulembo bw' *eyojwe*.

Yagil' ati, `Kolikula nkushwele.'
Ahi, "Kanakuzile talaizile kushelela."

Ahi, "Tata yansig' ahandi."

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 204-219:
She describes her ascent through the courts, the negative results at each level, and her final anger and despair.

Lines 220-235:
The king ponders the case only briefly, then decides it in favor of the woman (lines 220-21) and explains the basis of his judgment by explicating the metaphors in the previously used praise epithets.

NOTES

190 Come out: Traditionally, a bride is secluded for a period of time ranging from a few days, in the case of a previously married woman, to several months, in the case of a family who can afford to live without her productive labor.

POETIC STANZAS

190-193: similar to 148-151.

194-197: see note to 124-127.

198-203: see note to 128-134 (shortened by one line here).

204-214: mirror stanzas: introductory lines associated by repetition (204,205 and 210) followed by a stanza in **abab** (**a**'s: 206, 208 and 211, 213; **b**'s: 207, 209; 212, 214) formed as in 163-176, q.v.

215-219: stanza in **aaabb** formed by contrast between lines that cohere either by repetition of locutive + *mala* "And" (emphatic) *or* as 1st person future verb initial (**a**'s: 215-217) and lines that cohere by parallelism, verb initial + praisename (**b**'s: 218-219).

He met me just come out from bride's seclusion," she said.
"I'd spent a year inside.
He spoke of adult things, and I agreed.
"We came to lay down, O King," she said,
"And when we came to get up,

He took *the Drum of kings and men, the thing Well-spoken-of*,
The Sleeping-sickness, *Killer-of-cattle*,
The Plunderer of cattle and their offspring.
He called it *a Broken-mouth-vessel*!

It's not a keg calabash for fermented brew,
Nor a tankard for sweet mash.
What they call a *Broken-mouth-vessel*'
Is the resonator for the *enanga*
That's the one that booms though it's been split."
'Yes,' he said, 'It's a *Broken-mouth-vessel*.'"

"O King," she said,"I was greatly angered.
I came to the lower court and made my accusation.
All the officials judged me,
'Yes,' they agreed 'It's *a Broken-mouth-vessel*.'
And the royal kinsman judged me too,
'Yes,' he agreed, 'It's *a Broken-mouth-vessel*.'"

"I came here to the upper court," she said, "and made my accusation.
And all the elders judged me,
'Yes,' they agreed, 'It's a *Broken-mouth-vessel*.'
And even the Prime Minister judged me,
'Yes,' he agreed, 'It's *a Broken-mouth-vessel*.'"

"And I was greatly angered," she said.
"And I shall wail, I shall bellow,
I shall fall into the lake of salt I weep.
To take my *thingWell-spoken-of*,
Then they call it *a Broken-mouth-vessel*!"

The king inclined his head in thought; he raised it up.
"You truly win the case," he said.

Ahi, "Mbwenu anshangile nyalukile. Mazile omwaka gumoi.
Yangambila eby' abakulu, naikiliza.
Ahi, "Twagya twanyama, Mukama."
Ahi, "Katwaija twaimukile,

Yatola *Engoma y' abakama n' abashaija Mugambwage*,

Shotoka Nyamwita-nte,
Nyamunyagis' ente n' ogwayo.
Yagyeta *Mashayaye*!

Nti ti kishusi kya malwa
Mala ti kilele kya mulamba
Ekyobeta `*mashayay*e'
Luba lushusi lw' enanga
Nilwo lujuga lwatikile."
Ati, `Ego ni *Mashayaye*'"

Ahi, "Mukama natamwa muno.
Naija omu igombolola nahababa.
Abakungu bona bandamula,
Bati, `Ego ni *Mashayaye*.'
N' omwami nawe yandamula,
Ati, `Ego ni *Mashayaye*.'"

Ahi, "Naija hanu omu bulange, nahababa.

Abazee bona bandamula,
Bati, `Ego ni *Mashayaye*'
Na katikilo inya yandamula,
Ati, `Ego ni *Mashayaye*.'"

Ahi "Mala natamwa muno."
Ahi, "Mala ndachula ndabologa
Ndigwa enyanja y' omwonyu.
Okutola *Mugambwage* yange
"Bakagyeta *Mashayaye*!"

Omukama yainama yainuguka.
Ati, "Omushango nogusingakwo."

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 236-258:

The king determines fines for the judges who ruled erroneously in the lower courts (lines 236-246). He devises two punishments for the false lover, one corporal (lines 247-250) and one culinary (lines 251-58), and declares that the basis of the man's crime is sexual ignorance (lines 253 and 258; but the king apparently errs here — see line 70).

NOTES

227 Went inside: that is, died, in royal vocabulary.

232 White sheep: a sacrifice that is part of the ritual requirements of a traditional Haya marriage.

233 Nines: cowrie shells strung nine to a string and tied to the neck of an animal to be sacrificed.

242 Folding: see note to line 70

POETIC STANZAS

222-246: verse passage of two verses (222-235.2, 236-246) whose 5 constituent units are all composed as introductory line (222, 229, 234, 236, 243) + stanzaic pattern (223-228, 230-233, 235-235.2, 237-242, 244-246), described immediately below.

236-246: verse formed by a compound stanza and a stanza which are introduced by parallel first lines (236, 243) and cohere semantically as a judicial sentence; the compound stanza in **aab**, 2 + 2 + 2, is formed by contrast between couplets that cohere by repetition and parallelism (**a**'s: 237-238, 239-240) and a single couplet whose coherence internally between its lines and externally with the other couplets is solely semantic (**b**: 241-242); the stanza in **abab** is formed by contrast between lines composed as locutive + "elder" + [verb] + number (**a**'s: 244, 245) and lines composed as "prime minister" + [verb] + number (**b**'s: 244.1, 246); (the same stanza is alternately **aabb** by contrast between lines composed as judicial role + number a's:244, 244.1) and lines composed as judicial role + subjunctive verb + number > 10).

247-251: stanza in **aabb** formed by a couplet that coheres by initial locutive and enjambment (**a**'s: 247-248) contrasted with a couplet that coheres by repetition of "hit 25" (**b**'s:249-250); the final line coheres with the preceding one by syntactic parallelism of a 3rd person singular near past verb in initial position and by semantic contrast betweeen these verbs, "lie down" and "arise"; line 250 is thus a swing line, as is 237, 216

"Yes," he agreed, "It is *a thing Well-spoken-of*."
"Father's going to court my mother," he said,
Was going to hunt *the thing Well-spoken-of*."
"When I was born they kissed me," he said,
"They were kissing *the thing Well-spoken-of*."
"When father passed inside and I assumed the rule," he said, "they honored me.
They were honoring *the thing Well-spoken-of*."

"And it is truly *the Plunderer of cattle and their offspring*," he said,
"For when they demanded four cows in bridewealth,
They went. And those just born were carried with them.
And when they demanded a white sheep for the clan spirit," he said,
It also went, and with it nines of cowries."

"And it is truly the *Sleeping-sickness*, *Killer-of-cattle*," he said.
It bears syphilis,
It bears gonorrhea,
It bears tertiary syphilis, whose pain cannot be spoken."

"How many judged you in the lower court?" he asked.
"Ten officials judged me," she said,
"And the royal kinsman was the eleventh."
"Let each official pay you ten," he said,
And let the royal kinsman pay fifteen.
Calling it a *Broken-mouth-vessel* shows
They know nothing of the folding."

"How many judged you here?" he asked.
"The elders numbered nine," she said. "The Prime Minister was the tenth."
"Let every elder pay fifteen," he said.
"Let the Prime Minister bring you twenty-five."

"You man! You!" he said,
"The one who called it a *Broken-mouth-vessel*,
Lie down. They'll thrash you five and twenty."
Down he lay. They thrashed him five and twenty.

He arose and grasped the king's knees for mercy.
"Stand again," he said, "Let me make it perfectly clear."

Ati, "Ego ni *Mugambwage*."
Ahi, "Tata kugya kushwela mawe
Akaba nagya kuhiga *Mugambwag*e."
Ahi, "Kanazailwe banywegela."
Ahi, "Nibanywegela *Mugambwage*."
Ahi, "Tata kayatahize natwala engoma, bampabukya.

Nibahabukya *Mugambwage*."

Ahi, "Kandi ni *Nyamunyagis' ente n'og*wayo kwo."

Ahi, "Kabamwendize ente inai,
Zikagenda. Zizaile itwalile.
Ahi, "Kabamwendize katanga k' omuchwezi,

Nayo yagendwamu eby' enda."

Ahi, "Kandi ni *Shotoka Nyamwita-nte* kwo.

Egila akaho,
Egila ebingolo,
Egila emitezi olubabililo tilwakugambwa."

Ati, "Olamwilwe bangaha omu igombolola?"
Ahi, "Ndamwilwe abakungu ikumi.
Omwami niwe wa ikumi n' omoi."
Ahi, "Buli mukungu akulipe ikumi ikumi,
Omwami akulipe ikumi na itano.
Okugyeta *Mashayaye*,
Tibalikumanya mukunjagalo."

Ahi, "Hanunju walamulwa bangahai?"
Ahi, "Abazee mwenda. Katikilo niwe wa ikumi."

Ati, "Buli muzee akulipe ikumi na itano.
Katikilo agobye gabili na itano."

Ati, "Iwe mushaija! Iwe, iwe,"
Ati, "Ayagyesile *Mashayaye*,
Myama bakutele gabili na itano."
Yanyama. Bamutela gabili na itano.

Yaimuka yakwata omukama amagulu.
Ahi, "Shuba oyemelele nkugambilege."

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 259-273:
The king summons the woman's husband, who declares his respect with proper praise (lines 259-63), is deemed knowledgeable on this basis, and receives a culinary reward.

Lines 274-281:
The king concludes his judgment with an observation (lines 274-81) that, were it not for the misfortune of its placement, the vulva's call would be louder and more compelling than that of the king's own drum.

NOTES

268 Dear one: The term *baba* is used here as an exclamation.

270 Plantains: *Enshansha* bananas are a fitting reward, for they punningly refer to becoming happy *oku-shanshamuka*.

281 Its call: This final image is based on the sexual practice alluded to before (see note to line 21). The sound signified by the drum's call is the liquid sound that in turn signifies the vagina is ready to be entered. Audience reaction at the end of the song includes laughter.

POETIC STANZAS

253-258: stanza in **aba** formed by contrast between single lines that cohere by repetition (**a**'s: 253, 258) and a quatrain (**b**'s: 254-257) that itself coheres as a stanza in **abab**; its pattern is formed by contrast between lines composed as locutive + 3rd person plural subjunctive verb + direct object (**a**'s: 254, 256) and lines that begin "And" + direct object (**b**'s: 255, 257).

260-263: see note to lines 66-69.

265-268: stanza in **abab** similarly formed to that of lines 254-257.

269-273: compound stanza, 2 + 2 + 1, in **aab** formed by couplets (**a**'s: 269-270, 271-272) that cohere by internal repetition (269-270) by enjambment (271-272) and by shared final lines (270, 272) contrasted with a single line which puns to finalize the figure.

"So you'll know that you know nothing of *the folding*," he said,
"They'll boil *kagigi* beans for you
And *sholosi* beans that are black.
They'll cut *Bellower enshankala* plantains." he said,
And they'll cook you mole meat.
You know nothing of *the folding*."

A name he called–the husband who had followed after her.

"I call it *the thing Well-spoken-of*," he declared,
The Sleeping-sickness, *Killer-of-cattle*,
the Plunderer of cattle and their offspring.
I call it *the Short face with a Long nose*."

He said, "You know the folding."

"They'll boil *kamwami* beans for you," he said,
"And *kabanga* beans that are white.
They'll find you meat that's rich," he said,
"My friend, I say rich kidney or the richest of the brisket."

"They'll cut you *enshansha* plantains." he said.
Eat the *enshansha* plantains,
Because you called it *the thing Well-spoken-of*,
Eat the *enshansha* plantains,
Eat them, feel happy in all your body."

"But that *thing Well-spoken-of*," he said,
"*The Sleeping-sickness*, *Killer-of-cattle*,"
What caused its great misfortune was–" he said,
"Its roar was diminished by its downward turn.

Had they suspended it
Say, high upon the mountain at Ilogelo,
And had they put a drumstick to it,
Its call would have been greater than the drum's."

278-281: stanza in **abab** formed by contrast between lines that begin with conditional verbal inflections (**a**'s: 278,280) and lines that do not (**b**'s:279,281).

Ahi, "Kumanya otalikumanya *mukunjagalo*,"

Ahi, "Bakutogosheze empelege ez' akagigi
Na kyasholosi ezikwilagula."
Ahi, "Bakutemele Lubologa lw' enshakala.
N' enyama bakuchumbile ez' enfukuzi.
Tolikumanya *mukunjagalo*."

Eibala agyeta - iba akaba amuhondeile.

Ahi, "Inye ngyeta *Mugambwage*,
Shotoka Nyamwita-nte,
Nyamunyagis' ente n' ogwayo.
Ngyeta *Buso bugufi*, *Nyindo ndai*."

Ahi, "Iwe nomanya *omukunjagalo*."

Ahi, "Iwe bakutogosheze empelege ez' akamwami
Na kabanga ezilikwela."
Ahi, "Bakuhigile enyama eshaile,
Baba, nti enyama eshaile ez' ensigo anga enkolo ezishala muno."

Ahi, "Bakutemele ekitoke ky' enshansha.
Olye ekitoke ky' enshansha.
Olwo wagyesile *Mugambwage*
Olye ekitoke ky' enshansha,
Okilye oshanshamuke engingo."

Ahi, "Yonene *Mugambwage*,
Shotoka Nyamwita-nte,"
Ati, "Ekyagibuliz' obwaku
Ekaitw' okujug' ejumaile.

Kabakuba bagitungamize
Nka aha ibanga elihango elya Ilogelo,
Kabakugiteileho omuziyo,
Nekil' engom' okulaha."